

THERE ARE PLACES
THAT SHOULD NOT EXIST.

Adam is a young architect searching for inspiration. He finds an old apartment building that doesn't appear on any maps, any records, or any plans.

Apartment 407 should not exist.
The hallway should not exist.
The room behind the door should not have been built.

But the drawings are real.
The tenants were real.
And the truth...
has been waiting for him
long before he arrived.

The deeper Adam digs,
the more he realizes
the building is not the mystery.
He is.



A PSYCHOLOGICAL HORROR
ABOUT ARCHITECTURE,
MEMORY, AND THE SPACES
WE CAN NEVER ESCAPE.



[/Mostafa.Hebieshy](#)

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the author



THE ROOM THAT WAS NEVER BUILT

MOSTAFA HEBIESHY



407

THE ROOM THAT WAS NEVER BUILT

SOME DOORS ARE NOT MEANT TO BE OPENED.



MOSTAFA HEBIESHY

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Copyright

THE ROOM THAT WAS NEVER BUILT

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First Edition

Independently Published

Written by Mostafa Hebieshy

Dedication

To my beloved father,

Gamal Hebieshy

**You taught me that true strength is not measured by
how long we live, but by the love we leave behind.**

**Though you are no longer here, your wisdom, your
kindness, and your unwavering support continue to
guide every step I take.**

**This book is dedicated to your memory, with all my
love, gratitude, and respect.**

May you rest in eternal peace.

Mostafa Hebieshy

Quote

Some rooms are abandoned because people leave " them. Others are abandoned because they should never have existed in the first place".

Mostafa Hebieshy —

Introduction

Every building has a history.

Some are written in blueprints. Some survive only in forgotten memories.

But there are places that were never recorded... places that should not exist.

Adam believed he had rented an ordinary apartment in an aging building where nothing ever happened. He expected quiet nights, worn-out walls, and a chance to begin again.

Instead, he found measurements that made no sense. Voices that had no source. And a door hidden behind a wall where no room had ever been built.

The greatest horrors are not the ones that chase us.

They are the ones that quietly wait for us to open the wrong door.

Welcome to the room that was never built.

Chapter One

The Apartment That Shouldn't Exist

Adam had always believed that buildings were incapable of keeping secrets.

They were made of stone, steel, and concrete—silent witnesses to the lives that passed through them. People lied. Memories faded. Blueprints could be altered. But walls were only walls.

At least, that was what he believed before Apartment 407.

The advertisement had appeared late at night while he was searching for somewhere quiet to disappear from the noise of the city. The rent was impossibly low, the photographs were few, and the description consisted of only one sentence:

A peaceful apartment for someone seeking a new "beginning".

It sounded perfect.

The landlord was waiting outside the building when Adam arrived the following afternoon. He was an elderly man with tired eyes and a face that seemed older than the structure behind him.

You'll like the silence here," the old man said while "handing him the keys.

Adam smiled politely.

"I hope so".

The landlord hesitated.

"...For most people"

He stopped speaking.

Then he forced another smile.

"Never mind".

Adam almost asked what he meant, but curiosity had never been stronger than exhaustion.

The building stood alone at the end of a narrow street where traffic rarely passed. Its cracked walls carried decades of rain and dust. Several windows were sealed from the inside, while others reflected nothing but gray clouds.

Nothing about it looked frightening.

Only forgotten.

Apartment 407 was on the fourth floor.

There was no elevator.

Every step on the staircase echoed strangely, as though another pair of footsteps answered a heartbeat later.

Adam paused twice.

Both times...

The second footsteps stopped too.

He laughed quietly at himself and continued climbing.

Inside, the apartment looked exactly like the photographs.

Old furniture.

Faded wallpaper.

A narrow hallway connecting every room.

.Nothing unusual

He spent the next hour unpacking the few belongings he had brought with him.

A suitcase.

Several books.

A laptop.

A framed photograph of his parents.

By sunset, the apartment almost felt like home.

Almost.

It happened while he was carrying a chair into the hallway.

Something felt wrong.

Not visibly wrong.

Mathematically wrong.

The hallway looked longer than the apartment should have allowed.

Adam measured the distance with slow steps.

Then again using an application on his phone.

Nine meters.

He frowned.

He checked once more.

Still nine.

Curiosity replaced fatigue.

He walked outside and examined the emergency floor plan mounted beside the staircase.

Apartment 407 occupied the same space as every apartment below it.

According to the official blueprint...

Its hallway could not exist.

The apartment was nearly two meters deeper than the building itself.

Adam stared at the drawing.

Then at the apartment door.

.Then back at the blueprint

One of them was lying.

The building...

Or reality.

A cold draft passed through the hallway although every window was closed.

Behind him...

Apartment 407 creaked softly.

Not like old wood.

Not like settling concrete.

It sounded...

As though something inside had quietly shifted into place.

Adam looked back.

The apartment door was still open.

The hallway beyond it was empty.

Waiting.

For reasons he could not explain...

He suddenly felt that crossing its threshold again was no longer the same as entering it for the first time.

And without realizing it...

He counted his steps.

One...

Two...

Three...

As if somewhere deep inside, he already feared that the hallway might be longer than it had been only moments before.

Chapter Two

The Wall That Wasn't There

Adam barely slept that night.

Every time he closed his eyes, he remembered the impossible hallway.

Nine meters.

The number refused to leave his mind.

He tried convincing himself that the application on his phone had been inaccurate. Technology failed all the time. Measurements could be wrong.

Buildings could not be.

Morning brought no comfort.

The apartment felt colder than it had the day before.

Not freezing.

Just...

Unnaturally cold.

As he walked through the hallway, something caught his attention.

One section of the wallpaper reflected the morning light differently from the rest.

It was only a slight difference.

Enough for his eyes to notice.

Not enough for his mind to explain.
Adam stepped closer.
The wallpaper was old.
Its faded floral pattern had almost disappeared
beneath years of dust.
Yet one perfect rectangle remained untouched.
As though the paper there had never aged.
He frowned.
Carefully, he ran his fingers across its surface.
The texture changed.
The rest of the wall felt like cold concrete.
The rectangle...
Felt hollow.
Adam knocked once.
Nothing.
He knocked again.
Still nothing.
Then...
A knock answered from the other side.
One slow knock.
Exactly matching his own.
Adam stepped backward.

His heartbeat thundered in his chest.

He waited.

Silence.

Perhaps he had imagined it.

He forced himself to laugh.

Old pipes.

Old buildings.

Old imagination.

He turned away.

Knock.

This time...

He had not touched the wall.

The sound came again.

One knock.

Then another.

Then a third.

Each one separated by several long seconds.

**Adam grabbed the emergency blueprint he had
photographed the previous evening.**

According to the building's official plan...

There was solid concrete behind that wall.

No room.

No hallway.

No empty space.

Nothing.

The knocking stopped.

Slowly...

Adam leaned forward until his ear rested against the wallpaper.

At first, he heard only silence.

Then...

A breath.

Not his own.

Slow.

Weak.

As if someone had been standing there for a very long time.

Waiting.

His body froze.

The breathing stopped.

A whisper followed.

Not words.

Only broken sounds.

Like a voice that had forgotten how language worked.

Adam stumbled backward.

His shoulder struck the opposite wall.

The whisper disappeared instantly.

The apartment became silent once more.

Morning sunlight suddenly broke through the window.

**Adam looked back toward the strange section of
wallpaper.**

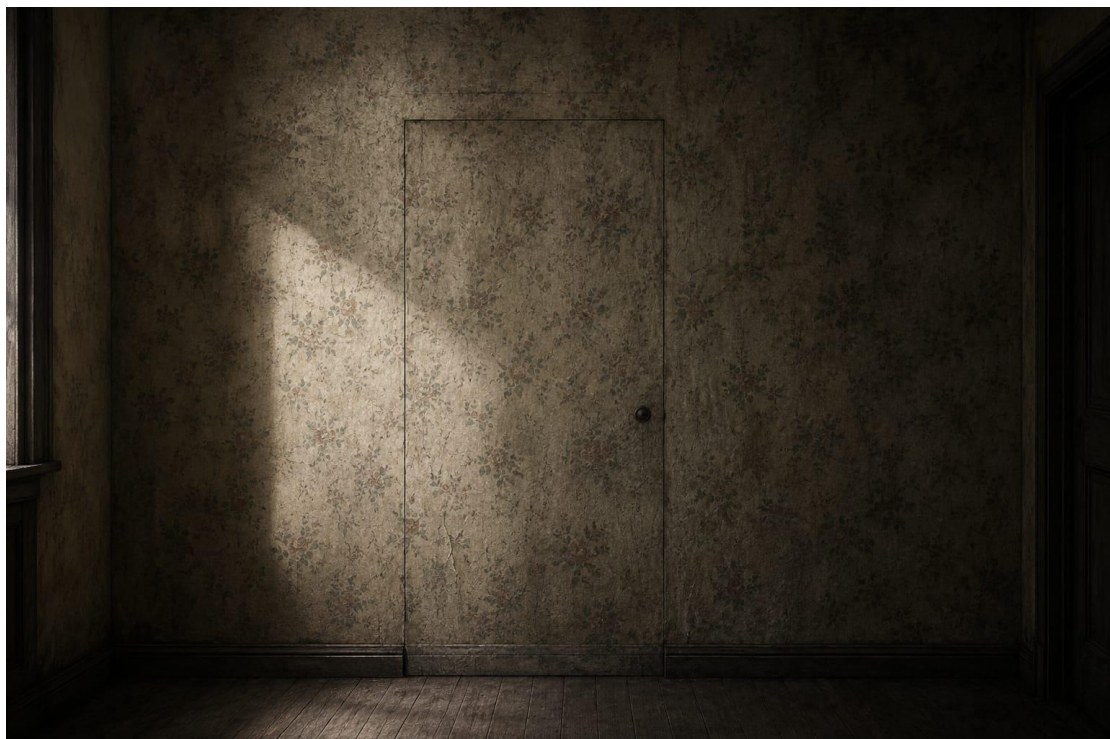
His eyes widened.

A faint outline had appeared beneath it.

Straight lines.

Perfect corners.

The unmistakable shape of a door.



A door that could not possibly exist.

He reached toward it.

His hand stopped only centimeters away.

Every instinct inside him screamed the same warning.

Do not touch it.

Adam lowered his hand.

Without another glance...

He walked away.

Behind him...

The wallpaper moved.

Only once.

As though something beneath it had quietly leaned
against the other side.

Chapter Three

The Door Without a Builder

Adam did not touch the wall again.

Not that morning.

Not the next night.

For two days, he avoided the hallway completely.

He left the apartment before sunrise and returned only after darkness had settled over the city. He convinced himself that fatigue had distorted his senses.

The impossible hallway.

The knocking.

The whisper.

Old buildings made strange noises.

That was all.

On the third evening, rain swallowed the streets outside.

Water struck the windows with a steady rhythm while distant thunder rolled across the sky.

The apartment felt colder than ever.

The lights flickered once.

Then again.

When they finally stopped trembling...

Adam noticed something impossible.

The wallpaper had changed.

Its faded floral pattern no longer matched the rest of the wall.

It had shifted.

Only a few centimeters.

Just enough to reveal a thin vertical crack.

Adam stood motionless.

He was certain that crack had not been there before.

Slowly...

He walked toward it.

The hallway seemed longer than he remembered.

Every footstep echoed twice.

Once beneath his feet.

Once...

Behind him.

He refused to turn around.

The crack stretched from the floor almost to the ceiling.

Cold air seeped through it.

Not ordinary cold.

It carried the scent of damp wood...

Old paper...

And something strangely familiar.

Adam reached out.

His fingers touched the loose edge of the wallpaper.

For several long seconds...

Nothing happened.

Then...

The wallpaper peeled back by itself.

Slowly.

Carefully.

As though unseen hands were opening it from the other side.

Behind it...

A wooden door emerged.



Dark.

Ancient.

Scarred by countless deep scratches.

It had no handle.

No keyhole.

Nothing except a small tarnished metal plate fixed at eye level.

Adam stepped closer.

Words had been carved into the metal.

"THIS ROOM WAS NEVER BUILT".

He whispered the sentence without thinking.

The moment the last word left his lips...

Knock.

A single heavy blow came from behind the door.

The floor trembled.

The lights went out.

Darkness flooded the hallway.

Adam could hear only his own breathing.

Then...

Another breath answered.

Slow.

Patient.

Not his own.

It came from the other side of the door.

So close...

As though someone had been standing there, listening to every heartbeat.

The lights returned.

The hallway was empty.

The door had vanished.

Only the old wallpaper remained.

Untouched.

As if nothing had happened.

Adam stared at the wall.

Minutes passed.

Then he noticed something lying near his feet.

A single rusty nail.

He bent down and picked it up.

It was warm.

Warm enough to feel as though it had just been placed there.

Someone...

Or something...

Had left it for him.

Adam closed his hand around the nail.

For the first time since entering Apartment 407...

He realized a terrifying possibility.

He was no longer searching for the room.

The room...

Had begun searching for him.

Chapter Four

The Room That Was Never Built

Adam kept the rusty nail in his pocket.

He could have thrown it away.

He almost did.

Yet every time he reached for it, he felt its strange warmth against his fingers.

It was as if the object refused to leave him.

Three nights passed.

Nothing happened.

No knocking.

No whispers.

No impossible door.

The silence became worse than the fear.

By the fourth night, Adam found himself standing in the hallway again.

He did not remember walking there.

Only that he was suddenly facing the same wall.

The wallpaper looked untouched.

He stared at it for several seconds.

Then...

The lights dimmed.

Not completely.

.Just enough for the shadows to grow

The air became heavy.

His ears rang with a low vibration that seemed to come from inside the walls.

Without warning...

The wallpaper began peeling away.

This time...

There were no invisible hands.

It simply fell.

Piece after piece.

Until the entire wall was exposed.

The wooden door stood there once more.

Waiting.

The metal plate still carried the same words.

"THIS ROOM WAS NEVER BUILT".

Adam took one slow step forward.

The rusty nail inside his pocket suddenly became hot.

So hot that he almost dropped it.

Before he could react...

The door opened.

Silently.

No hinges.

No creaking wood.

Only darkness.

Not ordinary darkness.

It seemed thicker than the night itself.

Like a place where light had never existed.

Adam stood at the threshold.

His breathing became shallow.

Every instinct told him to run.

Instead...

He stepped inside.

The room was impossibly large.

Far larger than the apartment.

Far larger than the building itself.



The walls disappeared into endless shadows.

The ceiling could not be seen.

The floor was covered with dust so untouched that every footprint became perfectly visible.

Except...

There was already a trail.

Fresh footprints.

Leading deeper into the darkness.

Adam looked down.

They matched his shoes.

Exactly.

But...

They were heading away from the door.

As though he had already walked into the room before.

Slowly...

He followed them.

The silence felt alive.

Every breath echoed back a second too late.

The footprints stopped in the middle of the room.

There...

A single wooden chair stood beneath a hanging light bulb.

The light swayed gently.

Although there was no wind.

Resting on the chair...

Was a black notebook.

Its cover was worn with age.

Adam opened it carefully.

Every page was blank.

Until the last one.

Only one sentence had been written.

In his own handwriting.

"Welcome back, Adam".

The light went out.

Complete darkness swallowed the room.

Then...

Someone whispered directly beside his ear.

"You took longer this time".

Chapter Five

The People Who Were Never There

Adam woke up on the cold wooden floor.

The room was gone.

The chair was gone.

The notebook was gone.

He was lying in the hallway of Apartment 407.

Morning light slipped through the dusty window as if nothing had happened.

For a long moment, he remained still.

Had he dreamed everything?

His eyes fell to his right hand.

The rusty nail was still there.

So was the thin layer of gray dust covering his shoes.

He slowly stood.

The wallpaper hid the wall once again.

No crack.

No door.

Nothing.

Yet the apartment no longer felt empty.

Someone...

Was watching.

Not from behind him.

Not from another room.

From inside the walls themselves.

Days passed.

Adam stopped going to work.

He stopped answering his phone.

The outside world began to fade.

Only Apartment 407 felt real.

One afternoon, he heard children laughing somewhere above him.

He frowned.

There was no fifth floor.

Curiosity overcame fear.

He climbed the staircase.

The fourth floor ended exactly where it should.

Above it...

Only the roof access door.

Locked.

The laughter stopped.

As he turned to leave...

He noticed tiny muddy footprints leading down the stairs.

Bare feet.

Too small to belong to an adult.

He followed them.

They ended outside Apartment 407.

Then...

Simply disappeared.

That night...

Someone knocked on his apartment door.

Three slow knocks.

Adam looked through the peephole.

A woman stood outside.

She looked frightened.

"Please"....

she whispered.

"Have you seen my son"?

Adam opened the door.

"There is no child here".

The woman stared at him in confusion.

"My son lives in Apartment 407".

Adam's heartbeat stopped.

"I live in Apartment 407".

Her face slowly lost all expression.

"No"...

she whispered.

"You do".

She stepped backward.

Her eyes filled with horror.

"As he did" ُ

Before Adam could ask what she meant...

She walked away.

The next morning, he asked the landlord about her.

The old man became silent.

"There has never been a woman living here".

Adam described her face.

The landlord turned pale.

Without saying a word...

He unlocked a dusty storage room beneath the stairs.

Inside were old tenant records.

Photographs.

Rental agreements.

Newspaper clippings.

Adam searched through them.

Then...

He found her.

The same woman.

The same face.

The same frightened eyes.



The photograph had been taken...

Thirty-two years earlier.

Below it...

One sentence had been written in fading ink.

"Resident of Apartment 407".

Status:

Missing

Adam's hands began to shake.

He turned the page.

Another photograph.

Another resident.

Missing.

Another.

Missing.

Every tenant of Apartment 407...

Had vanished.

Then...

He reached the final page.

There was one empty space left for a photograph.

Beneath it...

A name had already been typed.

Adam.

Chapter Six

The Last Blueprint

The empty space beneath Adam's name refused to leave his mind.

He returned to the storage room that same night.

The landlord was gone.

The building was silent.

The old records were exactly where he had left them.

Except...

One file was missing.

His own.

Adam searched every shelf.

Every box.

Nothing.

Then he noticed something lying beneath the table.

A rolled blueprint.

Yellowed with age.

Bound by a faded black ribbon.

His hands trembled as he untied it.

Across the top of the page, someone had written:

FINAL STRUCTURAL PLAN

**The building's outline looked familiar.
Until he counted the floors.
There were only three.
Not four.
Apartment 407 did not exist.
Neither did the hallway.
Nor the room.
Adam frowned.
He unrolled the blueprint farther.
Someone had drawn new lines over the original design.
Different ink.
Different handwriting.
The impossible hallway appeared first.
Then...
The hidden wall.
The wooden door.
Finally...
The room.
Every impossible change had been added later.
As though someone had rewritten reality with a pencil.
At the bottom of the page...
There was a signature.**

Adam's signature.



Not similar.

Not close.

Exactly his.

Below it...

A date.

Tomorrow's date.

His breathing stopped.

That was impossible.

He had never seen this blueprint before.

He had never signed it.

The lights above him flickered.

A low vibration spread through the floor.

The shelves around him began to shake.
Old photographs slid onto the ground.
Tenant files opened by themselves.
Every missing resident stared back at him.
One by one.
Then...
Every photograph changed.
The faces disappeared.
Leaving only empty silhouettes.
Except one.
Adam's.
His photograph had appeared where the empty space
had been.
He had never taken that picture.
Yet there he was.
Standing inside Apartment 407.
Looking directly into the camera.
Smiling.
He had never smiled like that.
A whisper drifted through the storage room.
Soft.
Calm.

Almost welcoming.

"The building doesn't remember the people".

A pause.

"It remembers the architect".

The blueprint slipped from Adam's hands.

On its reverse side...

Only one sentence had been written.

In fresh black ink.

As if it had appeared only seconds ago.

"Finish what you started".

The lights went out.

When they returned...

The blueprint had disappeared.

Only the black ribbon remained.

Coiled quietly at Adam's feet.

Chapter Seven

The One Who Never Left

Adam stood alone in the hallway.

The black ribbon lay at his feet.

The blueprint was gone.

Yet the words remained inside his mind.

"Finish what you started".

He looked toward the wall.

The wallpaper was peeling away once again.

Not slowly.

Not gently.

It fell all at once.

The wooden door stood before him.

Waiting.

This time...

It was already open.

Beyond it...

The room was brighter than before.

A pale white light filled the endless darkness.

Adam stepped inside.

The footprints were gone.

The chair had vanished.
Only one object remained.
A full-sized architectural table.
Covered with unfinished blueprints.
He moved closer.
Every drawing showed Apartment 407.
Every version was different.
In one...
The hallway never ended.
In another...
The room consumed the entire building.
In another...
The apartment did not contain Adam.
It contained someone who looked exactly like him.
The final blueprint lay beneath them all.
It was blank.
Except for one sentence.
"The Architect must choose".
A pencil rested beside it.
Adam picked it up.
The moment his fingers touched the wood...
The room changed.

Memories flooded his mind.
Not memories of childhood.
Not memories of his family.
Older memories.
Impossible memories.
He saw himself drawing impossible hallways.
Designing rooms larger than buildings.
Erasing walls.
Creating doors that led nowhere.
He remembered every missing tenant.
Not as strangers.
But as people who had entered searching for answers...
And never found the exit.
Adam dropped the pencil.
"I didn't build this" ...
he whispered.
A familiar voice answered from behind him.
"No".
Adam turned slowly.
Another Adam stood in the doorway.
Older.
Calmer.

Smiling.



"You built the first room".

The older Adam stepped forward.

"The building finished the rest".

Silence filled the endless room.

"Who are you"?

Adam asked.

The other man smiled.

"I'm the one who never left".

The light above them began to fade.

The room trembled.

Cracks spread across every wall.

The impossible space was collapsing.

The older Adam placed the pencil back onto the table.

"It needs one architect".

He looked directly into Adam's eyes.

"One must stay".

The room shook violently.

Adam closed his eyes.

When he opened them again...

He was standing outside the apartment building.

Morning sunlight warmed the empty street.

The building...

Was gone.

Only an empty lot remained.

As though nothing had ever been built there.

People walked past without noticing anything unusual.

Adam looked down.

His hand was empty.

No rusty nail.

No black ribbon.

No blueprint.

Only one folded piece of paper rested in his pocket.

He unfolded it.

It was a rental advertisement.

Exactly like the one that had brought him there.

Except...

One line had changed.

"Apartment 407 is now available".

At the very bottom...

A handwritten note appeared.

"Welcome home".

Epilogue

The newspaper arrived three days later.

Hidden among advertisements and local headlines...

One small article caught the attention of anyone patient enough to read it.

"Construction Begins on a New Residential Building".

No one considered it unusual.

The old empty lot had finally been sold.

Workers arrived before sunrise.

By noon...

The foundation had already been marked.

The architect opened the official blueprint.

He frowned.

There shouldn't be a fourth floor," he said".

The foreman looked at the drawing.

"There isn't".

The architect nodded.

He could have sworn he had seen something else.

He shook his head and continued working.

Late that evening...

After everyone had left...

A cold wind crossed the unfinished construction site.

The blueprint lying on the table turned by itself.

One page.

Then another.

Until it reached the final drawing.

There....

A single room had appeared.

No one had drawn it.

No one had signed it.

Yet it was there.

Hidden beyond every measurement.

Impossible.

Waiting.

The wind stopped.

Silence returned.

At the bottom of the page...

Fresh black ink slowly formed two words.

Apartment 407

The next morning...

The blueprint was completely normal again.

No extra room.

No strange handwriting.

Nothing.

The building was completed one year later.

Families moved in.

Children filled the hallways with laughter.

Life began.

Then...

One apartment appeared on the rental listings.

No tenant remembered seeing it before.

No official record explained where it had come from.

Its number was simple.

407.

And somewhere...

Behind a wall that should never have existed...

Someone quietly whispered...

"Welcome home".

Author's Note

Thank you for reading The Room That Was Never Built.

This story was never meant to be about ghosts or haunted buildings alone. It is about the spaces we cannot explain, the memories we cannot trust, and the questions that remain long after the last page is turned.

While writing this novel, I wanted to create an atmosphere where fear grows quietly—through silence, impossible architecture, and the feeling that reality itself may not be as stable as we believe. If, at any point, you found yourself questioning what was real, then this story achieved exactly what it was meant to do.

Every room holds memories.

Every building keeps secrets.

And sometimes...

The greatest mystery is not what waits behind the door.

It is why the door was waiting for us.

Thank you for taking this journey with Adam.

I hope this story stays with you long after you close the book.

Mostafa Hebieshy